



MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

The histamine bucket.

The simple idea that explains why you have symptoms — and why “the same food” affects you differently.

FROM ME, TO YOU

When I understood the picture of the bucket, everything fell into place. It's the most useful image I can give you — let me explain it.

With love, Cătălina

Founder, MyHistamate

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THE CONCEPT

Picture a bucket

Your body has a “bucket” for histamine. Imagine that every histamine-rich food, and every factor that triggers its release, adds a little into this bucket.

As long as your body manages to process and clear histamine quickly enough, the level in the bucket stays under control. But when the input is greater than the body's capacity to handle it, histamine starts to build up.

IMPORTANT

There isn't one same limit for everyone. Each person has their own “bucket size”, shaped by genetics, gut health, hormone levels and the body's overall state.

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THE INPUTS

What fills the bucket

- **Food**

Foods high in histamine or that trigger its release.

- **Stress**

The body releases histamine when you're on alert.

- **Poor sleep**

Less rest = less clearing.

- **Hormones**

Certain days of the cycle raise sensitivity.

- **Environment**

Seasonal allergens, pollen, dust, mould.

- **Slow transit**

Sluggish digestion lets histamine accumulate.

THE LIMIT

Every bucket has a limit

As long as your histamine level stays below your tolerance limit, your body manages it without trouble. The bucket doesn't need to be empty — it just needs to not fill beyond your body's capacity to cope.

That's why histamine intolerance isn't always about a single food. One day the bucket can be nearly empty, and your body handles a food with ease.

Another day — after a stressful stretch, a few nights of poor sleep, a sensitive phase of your cycle, or allergen exposure — the bucket may already be nearly full. In that context, the very same food that caused no problem yesterday can be the drop that makes it overflow. That's why reactions can sometimes seem unpredictable. It's not just about what you ate, but about everything that had already gathered in your bucket beforehand.

THE OVERFLOW

When it fills up, the symptoms appear

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- **Migraines & dizziness**
 - **Itching & flushing**
 - **Palpitations**
 - **Bloating & cramps**
 - **Congestion & sneezing**
 - **Fatigue & brain fog**

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INDIVIDUAL

Your bucket is yours alone

Some people have a bigger bucket and tolerate larger amounts of histamine without noticing any effect. Others have a smaller bucket and reach their tolerance limit sooner. The size of this bucket is influenced by many factors — from genetics and gut health to hormones, stress and the body's overall state.

That's why two people can eat the exact same meal and have completely different experiences. What one person tolerates well can be a problem for someone else. So it makes no sense to compare yourself with other people with HIT, or to look for a food list that works for everyone.

REMEMBER

General principles can help, but tolerance is deeply individual. In the end, what matters most is understanding your own body — noticing what fills your bucket and what helps it empty.

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THE OUTPUTS

What helps the bucket empty

- **Hydration**

Water supports clearing, steadily through the day.

- **Good sleep**

The body regulates histamine most during sleep.

- **Calming stress**

Less alert = less histamine released.

- **Fresh meals**

Freshly cooked, eaten soon, no leftovers.

- **Time**

Between meals, the bucket needs a chance to drain.

- **Regular transit**

A gut that works clears histamine out of the body.

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THE MECHANISM

The drainage system: the DAO enzyme

The body has its own ways of processing and clearing excess histamine. An important role is played by an enzyme called DAO (diamine oxidase), which helps break down histamine — especially the histamine that comes from food.

If histamine is what we collect in the bucket, DAO can be seen as the drainage system. The more efficiently this system works, the faster the body can process and clear the histamine that builds up.

DAO levels and activity differ from person to person, and when the clearing capacity is reduced, the bucket can fill faster than the body manages to empty it. The difference between how much goes in and how much comes out is the surplus that stays behind and fills your bucket.

REMEMBER

Alcohol and some medications block the DAO tap — so the bucket fills faster and drains more slowly.

THE STRATEGY

The key isn't to avoid everything

It's to manage your bucket so you have room for real life — for a dinner out, a birthday, a holiday, or simply the days when you can't control everything.

- **Leave room in the bucket**

On ordinary days, simpler choices give you more flexibility when you need it.

- **Think across a few days, not one meal**

Sometimes it's worth being more careful before an event or a demanding stretch.

- **Observe, don't judge**

A harder day doesn't mean you did something wrong. It's just information that helps you understand your own limits and patterns.

- **Seek balance, not perfection**

The goal isn't to live avoiding everything, but to find a way to manage your symptoms without them running your life.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

Let's clear up 3 confusions

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- ☐ *"I'm allergic to these foods."*
 - ☐ It's not an allergy — it's a matter of accumulated amount, not an immune reaction to a single food.
 - ☐ *"I have to cut out everything forever."*
 - ☐ No. The goal is to know your limit and reintroduce gradually.
 - ☐ *"Once I've found the right list, the problem is solved."*
 - ☐ No. A few basic restrictions help most people with HIT, but no list can replace observing your own body and its reactions.

REMEMBER

3 things to take with you

- Symptoms appear when the bucket overflows
- Your bucket is unique — don't compare
- The goal is free space, not total deprivation

THE GOOD NEWS

The bucket isn't permanent. Your body's capacity to handle histamine can change over time. As you identify the factors that fill your bucket, support your gut health, manage stress and learn what works for you, you may tolerate things that used to cause problems. The goal isn't to remove everything with histamine and live in fear, but to understand what affects your tolerance and find a balance that lets you live as normally as possible.

COMING SOON

Soon, you'll see your bucket

More than a journal, MyHistamate is a companion built specifically for people with histamine intolerance. It looks at what you take in and helps you understand, over time, what fills your bucket, what empties it, and how food, stress, sleep and your cycle affect your symptoms.

- **Your bucket level, daily**
See how much room you have left each day.
- **Personalised correlations**
Discover which factors affect your symptoms.
- **Photograph the menu**
Quickly find the options that suit you best.
- **Patterns and trends**
Understand what repeats and what's worth watching.

JOIN THE WAITING LIST

Be among the first to try it. Sign up free and I'll let you know the moment we launch. In the meantime, you'll get free resources, articles and useful information about HIT.

Now you know how you work.

Keep the bucket in mind and no day will catch you by surprise again. Be patient with yourself — you're learning a new language, the language of your body.

[Discover MyHistamate](#)

This guide is for informational purposes only and does not replace professional medical advice. Histamine intolerance varies greatly from person to person — always consult your doctor before making significant changes to your diet or treatment.